A free guide from Janeses

The Event Planning Starter Kit

A 12-week countdown checklist, a budget planner and a day-of timeline for weddings, birthdays and corporate events.

JANESES INTEGRATED SERVICES LTD

Your One-Stop Shop for Premium Services

Sunny Peace Plaza, Zaria Road, Jos, Plateau State, Nigeria

Step 1

Your 12-week countdown

Tick each box as you go. Shorter runway? Compress the timeline, but keep the order: **date, budget and venue first**, then the vendors that book up fastest (catering, decor, cake), then the details.

12+ weeks out

Lock the foundations

- [ ] Set your date and a realistic guest estimate
- [ ] Agree your total budget and who is paying for what
- [ ] Name one person as the final decision-maker
- [ ] Shortlist and book your venue
- [ ] Start the guest list (family, friends, VIPs)

8 to 12 weeks

Book the big vendors

- [ ] Book caterer, decorator and cake designer
- [ ] Choose your theme and colour palette
- [ ] Brides: choose attire and book makeup / parlor session
- [ ] Book photo and video; arrange sound and MC

4 to 8 weeks

Shape the experience

- [ ] Hold a menu tasting and a cake flavour tasting
- [ ] Approve the decor concept and venue floor plan
- [ ] Send invitations and open RSVPs
- [ ] Plan drinks and confirm rentals (tables, chairs, linen)

2 to 4 weeks

Put it in writing

- [ ] Finalise guest count and seating plan
- [ ] Get every vendor's arrival time and scope in writing
- [ ] Schedule final payments and keep receipts together

Final week

Prepare to enjoy it

- [ ] Reconfirm delivery and setup times with each vendor
- [ ] Pack an emergency kit (pins, tape, chargers, first aid)
- [ ] Share the day-of timeline with your core team

PLANNING TIP

Popular dates and festive-season weekends fill up first. Secure your venue, caterer and decorator before you spend time on smaller details.

Step 2

Your budget planner

Use the middle column as a **starting point**, not a rule. Every event is different: a wedding leans on attire and decor, a corporate dinner on catering and venue. Fill in your total first, then split it, and **set aside a contingency before anything else**.

My total budget: NGN _____

Category	Typical share	My budget (NGN)	Actual (NGN)
Venue and rentals	15 - 20%		
Catering and drinks	30 - 40%		
Decor and styling	10 - 18%		
Cake and desserts	3 - 6%		
Attire, bridal and beauty	8 - 12%		
Photo, video and entertainment	8 - 10%		
Logistics and miscellaneous	4 - 8%		
Contingency (keep this untouched)	8 - 10%		
TOTAL			

Five habits that protect your budget

- **Guest count drives everything.** Catering, drinks, seating and rentals all scale with it, so settle a number early and revisit it only with a reason.
- **Ask for itemised quotes.** You can only compare vendors fairly when each line (food, service staff, setup, delivery) is visible.
- **Put every agreement in writing**, including what is and is not included, payment dates and the cancellation terms.
- **Spend where guests will notice.** Food, comfort and one memorable focal point (a backdrop, an entrance, a cake) beat small touches everywhere.
- **Track as you pay.** Use the Actual column every time a deposit or balance goes out, so there are no surprises in the final week.

Step 3

Day-of timeline and vendor questions

Fill this in with your team a week before the event and share it with every vendor. The example rows show the level of detail that keeps a day calm.

Time	What happens	Who is responsible
7:00 am	Decor team arrives and begins setup	Decorator
11:00 am	Catering and drinks stations arrive	Caterer

Ask every vendor these six questions

- [ ] Is my date available, and what do you need to hold it?
- [ ] What exactly is included, and what costs extra?
- [ ] What is the payment schedule and the cancellation policy?
- [ ] Who will be on-site on the day, and how many people?
- [ ] What is your backup plan if something goes wrong?
- [ ] Can I see photos or references from similar events?

Want the details handled for you?

Janeses brings catering, cakes, bridal services, decor, drinks and event essentials under one roof. Book a free consultation and we will turn this plan into a day your guests remember.

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